

CreArtBox

Chamber music and multimedia ensemble - New York City - since 2013

BIOGRAPHY · 3530 CHARACTERS

Long biography

CreArtBox is a chamber music and multimedia ensemble based in New York City, founded in 2013 by flutist *Guillermo Laporta* and pianist *Josefina Urraca* and now in its 13th season. It gives its New York Series at The DiMenna Center for Classical Music, tours nationally with recurring engagements on the West Coast, and performs internationally in countries such as Japan, Spain, and the United Kingdom.

Recognized by *The New Yorker* as one of its "art and music top picks," praised by *Time Out* as "an ensemble devoted to multidisciplinary events," and described by *BroadwayWorld* as "wholly authentic, visually and aurally compelling," CreArtBox is celebrated for its ability to enhance the listening experience of live music through theatrical design while preserving the integrity of each composition.

The 2026/27 season runs from October to August: four productions at The DiMenna Center, eleven works drawn from the ensemble's open Call for Scores, one world premiere, touring dates in Illinois, Kentucky and the Hudson Valley, a residency at the Kuopio Conservatory in Finland, and the seventh Festival ADAR in Asturias.

CreArtBox has run an open Call for Scores since its first season, alongside a composer residency program, fostering the creation of new works and mentoring emerging voices. Over the past decade it has presented works by Pulitzer Prize winners Caroline Shaw and David Lang and by Timo Andres, Anna Clyne, Nico Muhly, Joshua Penman, Andrea Casarrubios, Hannah Selin, Dai Wei, Brian Wysocki, Annamaria Kowalsky and Cullynn Murphy, among many others.

Composers reaching the current season through the call include Eric Moe, a Guggenheim fellow honoured by the American Academy of Arts and Letters; Zygmund de Somogyi, a Royal Philharmonic Society composer for 2025 and Festival ADAR's composer in residence; Eli Tausen á Lava, nominated for the 2026 Nordic Council Music Prize; and Paul Novak and Sam Wu, both winners of the ASCAP Foundation's Morton Gould Young Composer Award.

Each core member brings a distinctive artistic trajectory: Laporta has combined a career as a flutist with theater directing and lighting design; Urraca is an acclaimed solo and chamber pianist with deep ties to Spanish repertoire; Gendron is a longtime member of the Momenta Quartet and one of the concertmasters of the Orpheus Chamber Orchestra; Cohen is the newly appointed violist of the Formosa Quartet; and Yang is a founding member of the Naumburg-winning Merz Trio.

The project was originally conceived in 2006 in Europe as Cre.Art Project by Laporta and clarinetist/performance creator Tagore González, and re-established in New York City in 2013. Since then CreArtBox has produced a series of theatrical and interdisciplinary works, including *Architecture of a Common Man* (2023), the opera-ballet *Two Roads* (2020), *Visuality* (2012/14), the opera *Noctum* (2011), the musical *London: The Show* (2009), and *Cre.Art Project I* (2006).

The ensemble has been awarded the Queens Council on the Arts New Work Grant and the New York Foundation for the Arts Fellowship, and is supported by the New York State Council on the Arts, the NYC Department of Cultural Affairs, the Amphion Foundation, the Alice M. Ditson Fund, and the Aaron Copland Fund for Music. In addition to its American-based activities, CreArtBox co-produces Festival ADAR, an international arts festival held since 2021 in Asturias, Spain, dedicated to revitalizing rural communities through music, contemporary creation, artist residencies, and site-specific projects.